

Competitor Brief: YouthWorks

Prepared by the GBF Development team

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Summary

YouthWorks is a government-backed youth training initiative that launched in Binh Duong in November 2025. It offers a free six-week training course with an official government certificate. It has strong public funding and a recognised brand.

How it compares to GBF

Feature	YouthWorks	GBF Skills Forward
Cost to young person	Free	Free
Duration	6 weeks	16 weeks
Paid internship	No	Yes (8 weeks)
Government certificate	Yes	No
Published placement rate	Not disclosed	71% (2024)

Assessment

YouthWorks' key weakness is the absence of an internship, which is the part of our model most associated with real job outcomes. However, 'free and fast and certified' is attractive, and our field staff estimate that up to 40 per cent of our current waitlist would switch to YouthWorks if it had the capacity to take them.

The Development Director's view is that the threat is overstated because YouthWorks cannot place young people into jobs. Field staff in the border districts disagree. The truth is probably somewhere in between and worth testing against the data.